

Shuaib Salar Ahmed

NOC | Network Support | Infrastructure Operations

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Professional Summary

Austin-based network support technician with 10+ onsite contracts and hands-on experience isolating connectivity faults, tracing switchports, restoring VoIP and network printing, and coordinating with remote support teams. Cisco Enterprise Core specialist, CCNA, and Security+ prepared for NOC coverage, infrastructure support, incident response, and remote network operations.

Certifications

Cisco Certified Specialist - Enterprise Core (350-401 ENCOR), Sep 2026-Sep 2029 | Cisco Certified Network Associate (CCNA), Sep 2024-Sep 2027 | CompTIA Security+, Sep 2025-Sep 2028 | Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals, earned May 2024

Fortinet NSE 4 - FortiOS 7.6 Administrator exam, passed Jun 2026

Technical Skills

Network operations: Layer 1-3 troubleshooting, connectivity testing, switchport tracing, VoIP, incident documentation, remote escalation, rack and cabling support

Routing and switching labs: Cisco IOS, VLANs, STP/RSTP, Rapid PVST+, EtherChannel, OSPF, EIGRP, BGP, IPv4/IPv6, ACLs, NAT/PAT, DHCP, DNS, ARP, ICMP

Tools: Wireshark, Cisco Modeling Labs, EVE-NG, Packet Tracer, FortiGate, Active Directory, VMware, Python, PowerShell, Linux, Windows

Relevant Experience

Independent Network and Infrastructure Technician | Contract engagements through Field Nation

Jan 2025-Present

- Completed 10+ onsite technology and infrastructure contracts through Field Nation across retail, healthcare, and banking environments.
- Restored healthcare VoIP and network connectivity by tracing a device MAC address to the correct switchport, identifying a disconnected switch uplink with a remote NOC, and replacing a failed legacy IP phone.
- Restored network printing during a Walgreens field engagement without unnecessary hardware replacement.
- Troubleshot infrastructure and network issues during Best Buy field work and coordinated remediation with remote technical support.
- Documented conduit pathways, telecom rooms, rack layouts, cabling constraints, and equipment placement for a Verizon 5G carrier site survey.

Selected Projects

ARP and Packet Analysis Lab: Physical network lab; captured ARP requests and replies with Wireshark and documented Ethernet, ARP, and ICMP behavior from raw frames through routed forwarding.

Active Directory and DNS Troubleshooting Lab: VMware lab; separated IP reachability from DNS-based domain discovery, repaired stale client state, and verified domain login and group-token results.

Education

University of Maryland Global Campus - B.S. Cybersecurity Technology, expected 2027 | Houston City College - Computer Science studies, 2019-2026